The Vajra Beak, the Commitment of the Nāgas

Vajratuṇḍa-nāma-nāgasamaya · Toh 964 · Derge Kangyur
རྡོ་རྗེ་རྣྀཧ་ཊྲས་བ་ཏྲ་ཀཱན་ཏི་དམ་ཚིག

The Vajra Beak, the Commitment of the Nāgas, known in Sanskrit as Vajratuṇḍa Nāma Nāgasamaya and in Tibetan as Dorje Chu Zhejawa Lui Damtsik, is a ritual scripture concerned with the nāgas, the serpent-like beings of Buddhist cosmology associated with water, weather, and disease. It opens with the Buddha teaching in the great city of Gyokdor before a vast assembly of nāgas, led by figures such as Takṣaka, along with gods and humans. The narrative then turns to a wealthy brahmin youth named Peerless Eye, a master of the Vedas and of mantra, who repeatedly summons the nāgas and makes fire offerings to them. This sets the stage for the binding commitments placed on the nāgas and the protective practices the text offers. It is Toh 964 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī and ritual texts that preserve spells and rites for protection and well-being.

In the language of India: vajratuṇḍa nāma nāgasamaya. In the language of Tibet: The Vajra Beak, the Commitment of the Nāgas.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

At that time the Blessed One was staying in the great city of Gyokdor. To a vast assembled retinue, a retinue of nāgas such as Takṣaka and a great retinue of hosts of gods and humans, he was teaching, for the great benefit of beings, the Dharma that fulfills every wish and hope and brings happiness.

In that city there lived a brahmin youth called Peerless Eye. He was rich, with great wealth and great means, and well furnished with abundant goods and possessions. He had mastered the Vedas and their ancillary sciences, was practiced in mantra, and had accomplished mantras. Again and again he summoned the nāgas and performed fire offerings.

Just as that brahmin's crops were ripening, the rain stopped. So, reciting mantras in a proud voice, he declared, "I shall bring down a stream of rain and summon the nāgas!" He laid out a fire offering and offered sesame, rice and white mustard seed mixed with hot oil. Then he made an image of a fierce nāga, empowered an iron ritual dagger with mantra, and drove it into the crown of the nāga's head. The crown of the nāga's head split open, and the nāga felt intense pain.

That nāga was deeply agitated and enraged. In an instant, a moment, a flash, it did great harm with the force of the nāgas' pervading power. It sent out from its own body scorching rays that raised dust, covered everything with great harm, and burned the brahmin's fields. It also brought down a great torrent of rain falling as tongues of flame upon the brahmin's body. The brahmin was left without protector, without refuge, without ally. He abandoned his fire offering and, thinking to flee and seek protection, refuge and support from the Blessed One, he ran to the Blessed One. Arriving where the Blessed One was, he touched the Blessed One's feet and said:

"Blessed One, a wrathful nāga means to destroy my life, and I have no refuge. Blessed One, please protect me! Sugata, please protect me!"

Then the Blessed One comforted the great brahmin and said, "Great brahmin, do not be afraid. I shall be your protector, your refuge and your ally." Having said this, he remained silent.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please look! Even right before your eyes, the wild nāgas ruin the crops. Blessed One, after you have passed into complete nirvāṇa, in later times, in the age to come, who will be the support of all beings? What will become of them? Blessed One, for the sake of all crops, please teach that which keeps the crops from being scorched, guards them on every side, makes them flourish abundantly, preserves the crops and turns back the nāgas."

Then the Blessed One said to Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, there is a dhāraṇī called the Hidden Vajra Essence, which drives away the nāgas. It is the essence of the tathāgatas and their mudrā, spoken by the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas of the past, and I shall explain it. Because it swiftly blocks harm, all crops will swiftly be protected; they will be well guarded. Great ravines of fire will seal off all the nāgas in every one of the ten directions. Great clouds in tiers of blazing flame, tiers of cloud called the Force of the Garuḍa's Outspread Wings, will cover the sky. All crops, flowers and fruits will remain fully guarded. By it, all nāgas and the rest will be set wholly ablaze. The wild nāgas will be ruined, and they will be brought to terms."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, for the benefit of all beings, please speak the mantra words of this great dhāraṇī."

Then the Blessed One spoke this essence mantra:

namo bhagavate sarvabuddhānāna namo bhagavate śākyarājāya oṃ jvala jvala girībabhani dīptavega mahābade bhagavate mahācaṇḍa hṛdaya salani huru huru hara hara daha daha paca paca sarva sasyaṃ nāśaya nāgakula baṃśandhara dhara brasara caṇḍavega mahābala parākrama sphurita raudra baktra matha matha prajvayamāla dhāraṇī caṇḍavegavati praparbimandhāraṇī hūṃ hūṃ balavati begavati sara sara bisara bisara saranti sarva sadrisya nanāma dribanaya dribuya phala phaṭ drasandhāraṇī apa sarvantu sarva nāgtoṣa sarva babha babhani bagata begapati svāhā hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ nāga bisarani phaṭ jvalamālini phaṭ jvalamālini phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

The moment the Blessed One had spoken this knowledge mantra, which ruins all nāgas and all wild nāgas, every nāga and great nāga was struck with pain in the brain. Their bodies rotted, festered and stank. They touched their heads to the Blessed One's feet and said:

"Blessed One, you have spoken mantra words of utmost ferocity. Blessed One, though we do not recall having done any wrong, Blessed One, when the vidyādharas do us harm, when they scorn us, beat us, bind us, drive us out and harm us, at that time, Blessed One, the wild nāgas are stirred up. Then they ruin crops, flowers and fruits, bring down hail, cause turmoil with frost and wind, and bring excessive rain, no rain at all, or rain out of season. Blessed One, the vidyādhara who recites mantras should abide in loving-kindness, should put on the armor of loving-kindness, and should hold in his hand the sword of loving-kindness, for loving-kindness pacifies all that does harm."

"Blessed One, from this day on we wish to make a vow before the Tathāgata. Wherever this queen of knowledge mantras (vidyārājñī) is practiced, there, Blessed One, the nāgas will do no harm. Wherever protection has been made by this heart dhāraṇī, wherever it has guarded, sheltered, held and protected, wherever a cord has been stretched, boundaries have been sealed and a maṇḍala has marked the bounds, there, Blessed One, we will always and continually turn back all harm. We will guard all crops, flowers and fruits on every side. We will protect them. We will guard them on every side even from thieves, from cheats, from wild animals and from birds, and from then on we will do no harm."

Then the Blessed One granted his "Excellent!" to those lords of the nāgas: "Excellent, excellent, lords of the nāgas! Do just that. Guard Jambudvīpa with

good protection."

After that, the rite that accomplishes all activities and makes them auspicious shall be set out.

When crops are being harmed, the vidyādhara should make a square maṇḍala in the middle of the field, on a rooftop, or in a high place, and set four full vases in the four directions. Loose flowers should be strewn and laid out. Seven coiled figures should be made. Seven coils made of rice should be made, and over each figure the dhāraṇī should be recited twenty-one times. Rice mixed with milk porridge, curd and milk should be set out. Bells should be placed in the four directions. A torma of flour shaped like a lotus should be placed, as before. In the center of the maṇḍala a large vase should be placed and filled with the five products of the cow, milk and water. White mustard seed and parched rice should be put into it. The mantra should be recited sixty times.

Four pegs of khadira wood and one peg of iron should be made, all of them eight finger-widths in length. Four nāga figures should be made from the dung of a tawny cow or from flour, and placed at the four corners of the maṇḍala. The khadira pegs should be driven into their hearts until they sink in. The mantra should be recited one hundred and eight times. In the east a seven-headed nāga should be placed; in the west, an eight-headed one; in the south, a five-headed one; in the north, a three-headed one; and in the center of the maṇḍala a nine-headed one should be placed. Five incense bowls, one for each, should be placed. Over white mustard seed mixed with parched buckwheat, one should recite twenty-one times, and it is scattered in the four directions.

This dhāraṇī is written out, tied to the top of a banner, and planted at the four corners of the maṇḍala. It is also planted in the middle of the field. It is also planted in the middle of the pleasure garden. As soon as it is planted, the four directions will be sealed off on every side by great mountain gorges. As long as the peg has not been pulled out, there will be a great sealing of the boundaries. All crops, flowers and all fruits will be well protected. Not even a single leaf will wither, let alone branches and stalks. All kinds of creatures, wild animals and birds alike, will have their mouths bound. Even if they try to do harm, they will not be able to. In that place neither wind, clouds, hail, frost nor untimely wind will be able to cause ruin. Even if the nāgas inflict harm, they will not be able to cause ruin. If something has been ruined, it will flourish once

more. It will again have strength, abundance and luster.

If the contents of the large vase are sprinkled in all four directions of the field, the park and the pleasure garden, all creatures will disappear. Snakes, rats, mongooses, shrews, bears, frogs, flies, gnats and winged creatures will disappear. All ants and beetles will disappear. Even butterflies and the like will never appear. Neither those born from heat and moisture, nor those born miraculously, nor even those born from eggs will be able to cause ruin. The various kinds of creatures born from dampness and from flowers will likewise never appear, as long as the peg has not been pulled out. As long as the peg has not been pulled out, the various kinds of harm from nāgas will not arise and will not occur at all. There will be well-being and good harvests, and all crops, flowers and fruits will come to full maturity. They will become tasty and tender. All the nāgas too will always and continually guard, protect and shelter them.

One should recite twenty-one times over powder; if it is sprinkled on the crops, flowers, leaves and trees, all creatures will drop off and disappear. The insects called traimabuka and trailata, venomous snakes, eight-legged creatures and other kinds of creatures as well will disappear as long as the peg has not been pulled out. They will not appear.

A pacifying rite should be performed in the four directions of the field. If a fire offering is made of barley, wheat, sesame, white mustard seed and rice mixed with butter, there will be great pacification. Even those who have gone to birth as animals will not be able to cause ruin.

This dhāraṇī and the whole of the rite as it is given should be written out. One draws the Buddha, the Blessed One, the great sage Casting Off Faults and Vajradhara, ties this to the top of a banner, and plants it in a high place. Torma, flowers and incense are also offered. If one recites a thousand times over a khadira peg eight finger-widths long and plants it on the rooftop, all wind, frost, clouds and hail will be overcome.

The creatures that ruin crops, flowers, fruits, and leaves will disappear: gadflies, flies, picilikas, rats, bees, traimabukas, trailatas, viśakitakas, shellfish, fish, lomikas, frogs, mongooses, pigs, kantikas, lions, centipedes, one-footed creatures, turtles, ants, honeybees, field bees, bumblebees, black ones, śaṅganikas, those that come up from beneath the ground, māluśikas, owls, rats, long-snouted creatures, and all other kinds of creatures will disappear. They will not arise. All of them will perish. Crows, sparrows, swallows, pigeons,

madurikas, owls, khanajanakas, parrots, partridges, and all the rest will disappear.

One should recite this mantra over a ritual peg and bind the directions:

namo buddhāya oṃ kili mili catte meri li caṇḍa caṇḍe bandhaya svāhā

Then the great sage Casting Off Faults, who was sitting not very far from the Blessed One, heard this dhāraṇī, rose from his seat, touched the feet of the Blessed One with his head, and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I shall bind the mouths of all kinds of creatures that intend harm, that intend great harm, that carry poison, and that ruin crops, flowers, fruits, leaves, stalks, and roots. I shall turn them back. I shall threaten them. I shall make a great boundary of one league in all four directions. I shall guard on every side. Blessed One, in the future, in later times, I shall turn back all who intend harm and all who intend great harm. I shall then make the words of the mantra clear. Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings and out of compassion for me, please bless this."

The Blessed One said: "Great sage, with my blessing, speak the words of the dhāraṇī mantra for the benefit of all sentient beings and to protect the crops, flowers, fruits, and gardens."

Then the great sages, sitting before the Blessed One, spoke these words:

namo bhagavate śākyarājāya tathāgatāya namo agastāya mahāṛṣaye tadyathā kṣami cuyi cala cara cara homili bandhani nāśani daha daha sumuri cari sarva duṣṭaṃ bhandhani tuṇḍa bandhani sara saraṇi kṣu kṣu kṣu mani śuri vi sara sara hali tuli huti huti sara mani sarandu sarva pāpa pānag kṣudhali svāhā

As soon as the great sage Casting Off Faults had spoken this spell before the Blessed One, all the nāgas, yakṣas, and rākṣasas that intended harm fell flat on their faces and wailed to the Blessed One in loud voices: "Blessed One, we have been wicked. The sage's curse has fallen upon us. Blessed One, we are burned by the fire of the sage's curse. We are burned all over. Blessed One, from now on we will not do violence to the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa. Blessed One, from now on we will not ruin crops, flowers, fruits, or leaves. We will turn back all kinds of creatures."

The Blessed One said to them: "Lords of the nāgas, do just that! Protect all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa, so that their crops, flowers, fruits, leaves, and branches flourish happily everywhere."

Then that great sage described the rite to be performed: "Blessed One, one sits facing east, fills a bhṛṅgāra pitcher with water, and recites over it one hundred and eight times this spell, the heart of the great sage. Then, keeping the silence of a sage, one scatters the water in the four directions."

abasara sara śapata padāma hridaya krodha amuka bandhaya pranacara sumuru cala svāhā

"One recites this mantra seven thousand times. By the mere recitation, all the nāgas that intend harm will be tormented by heat. All kinds of creatures, from two-footed to four-footed, will be tormented by the curse, and all of them will flee. Never again will they harm the crops in that region. All kinds of creatures will be gone. Even afterward, all kinds of creatures will be gone. Never again will they ruin crops, flowers, fruits, or leaves."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the great sage, saying "Excellent!": "Excellent, excellent, great sage! Act in such a way that all sentient beings are by all means well protected, and that all crops, flowers, and fruits are well protected."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, said to the Blessed One: "In the future, in later times, as I shall safeguard and fully protect them, may the Blessed One please bless this."

"Excellent, excellent, Vajrapāṇi! Protect all sentient beings completely."

The rite for the nāgas who harm crops is complete.

After that, the Blessed One, with a great train of attendants, a great assembled retinue, a great array, great unfailing power, and the display of great miracles on every side, went to the abode of the Great King Vaiśravaṇa. When the Blessed One had arrived not very far from the abode of Vaiśravaṇa, there was in that region a forest called the Twentyfold Wilderness Forest. In a clearing of that forest there was a pool, and by the power of that pool the fields around the palace of Aḍakavatī, its parks, forests, leaves, flowers, and fruits were all fully nourished. Men, women, boys, girls, cattle, horses, mares, buffaloes, elephants, donkeys, and all the multitudes of people were filled with happiness.

That pond measured two yojanas across on each of its four sides. It was covered all over with many kinds of flowers: blue lotuses (utpala), lotuses, white water lilies (kumuda) and white lotuses (puṇḍarīka). In it were fish of many kinds, water creatures, fish-swallowers (timiṅgila), child-killing water

monsters (śiśumāra) and bees of many forms.

Then a drought came upon it. At that time all the groves, flowers, fruits, leaves and branches dried up, and the flowers withered. As the water shrank and only a little remained, the fish, water monsters, fish-swallowers, child-killing water monsters and bees of many forms ran in the ten directions. They ran everywhere, they ran wildly. Facing the end of their lives, facing the cutting off of their lives, they ran with pounding hearts.

Then the Blessed One came to that pond together with his great attendant. There he saw many hundreds of thousands of fish, water monsters, child-killing water monsters and bees, facing the end of their lives, facing the cutting off of their lives, running in the ten directions, and he looked on them with compassion. With compassion that took them as the object of his loving-kindness, the Blessed One sighed. With the sound of a snap of his fingers he called the nāgas, snapping his fingers two and three times, and made the sound resound throughout the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a thousand million worlds. Through some condition of their past karma, those creatures did not die. But the great nāgas did not hear that sound, nor did they call the Blessed One to mind.

Then the yakṣa of the māra lineage called Scattering Wind made a proclamation throughout the great trichiliocosm: "Seven days from now the eon of burning will come. From the Peak of Existence down to the hell of Avīci, the Hell of Ceaseless Torment, it is impossible that anything at all will escape being burned. A great terror has arisen in the world!" So the sound resounded.

Then all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans heard that sound and wept, saying, "Alas, alas! The world has become terrible!"

Then, although the Blessed One knew that this was being experienced through the conditions of karma, he nevertheless took thought. Rays of light came forth from the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's brows. Those rays illuminated all the abodes of the nāgas, then turned back and dissolved into the crown protuberance on the top of his head.

Then the nāga king called Encircled All Around in the Shape of a Parasol gathered all the nāgas and spoke these words: "O nāgas and great nāgas, why have these rays of light come forth, and through what condition have they appeared in the world?"

Then the great nāga king Sāgara reflected, and saw that the rays had come forth through the power of the Blessed One. Then the nāga king Sāgara and other mighty nāga kings went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they touched the Blessed One's feet and said these words: "Blessed One, what is the cause, what is the condition, for sending forth these rays of light? What is the cause, what is the condition, for sending forth rays of light, illuminating all the dwellings, and drawing them back again?"

The Blessed One said, "O lords of the nāgas, many hundreds of thousands of living creatures are perishing, because their lives are coming to an end."

Then, in an instant, in a moment, in a flash, the nāga king Sāgara filled the pond with water from streams of rain and satisfied the creatures with bliss.

Then a great open space appeared in that region, and in that place the Blessed One sat in the center, surrounded on all sides by a great retinue and honored before them. The great retinue of nāgas assembled there was as follows: eighty thousand nāga kings, the nāga king Sāgara and others. The nāga king Encircled All Around in the Shape of a Parasol rose from his seat and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he touched his head to the Blessed One's feet, bowed, and circled him three times. He made offerings to the Blessed One of flowers, incense, garlands, perfumes, unguents, ornaments, pennants and garments of many kinds, and then sat before the Blessed One.

Then the four kings bowed toward where the Blessed One was with palms joined, and said these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, a great and unbearable terror has arisen in the world, for a drought has come and it has become a wasteland of famine. Blessed One, since through this suffering all beings have become without protector, without refuge and without ally, may the Blessed One please teach mantra words suited to this. Please teach the words of a dhāraṇī mantra by which, in later times, in the age to come, the world that has fallen into many kinds of suffering may be delivered everywhere; by which excessive rain, lack of rain, untimely rain, hail, frost and heat may be prevented; by which wastelands of famine may be done away with entirely; and which serves to avert them and to give full protection."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the great king Vaiśravaṇa, the great king Dhṛtarāṣṭra, the great king Virūḍhaka and the great king Virūpākṣa: "Great kings, there is a heart dhāraṇī mantra of the nāgas, words that spur them on, called Lightning Blazing All Around. By merely calling it to mind, the

abodes of all the nāgas and the bodies of all the nāgas will burst into flame. The hearts of all untamed nāgas will pound. The heads of all the nāgas will split into seven pieces. Their eyes and heads will crack, break into fragments and crumble away. Great kings, take it up for the sake of the nāgas who intend harm and who intend great harm, and for the sake of all beings."

Then the four great kings touched both feet of the Blessed One and said these words:

"Blessed One, please teach the words of the nāga-heart mantra that urges the nāgas on, called Lightning Blazing All Around."

Then the Blessed One looked about with the gaze of the nāgas and the gaze of the Tathāgata, and said to the whole assembly of nāgas gathered there: "Lords of the nāgas, hear from me the mantra words of the dhāraṇī:

tadyathā oṃ vipule bravare nāge mahānāgahṛdaya āvarte jvala jvala sarvanāgahṛdayāni kimi kimi nāgakulavidhvansani hana hana sarvanāgaduṣṭāṃhṛdayāni hana hana sarvaduṣṭāṃnāgabhapanāni paca paca pacaya sarvaduṣṭāṃnāgānāṃ akṛma akṛma samudrāsāgara vimale vikrame mahānāgagate javare svāhā"

As soon as the Blessed One had spoken these words of the nāga-heart dhāraṇī mantra, all those nāgas trembled, and their bodies rotted and gave off a foul stench. Their bodies were wreathed in smoke as if by blazing fire, and they writhed and rolled about. All of them wailed loudly before the Blessed One, and all of them said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, you have spoken exceedingly terrible mantra words. Blessed One, there will be no guile in the hearts of any of us. Blessed One, we are all scorched, we who were vicious. Blessed One, from this day on we will be compliant. We make a vow before the Blessed One. Blessed One, as long as we dwell in the nāga realm of birth, Blessed One, we will do no harm in Jambudvīpa. We will not be vicious. We will make all flowers, branches, fruits and crops flourish fully. We will make streams of rain fall in their proper seasons. We will bring happiness and joy. We will bring all crops, flowers and fruits to ripeness. We will follow the command of the Tathāgata. We will abide by the pledge of truth. We will protect all sentient beings as one would an only child. Blessed One, in whatever region this queen of knowledge is practiced, there, Blessed One, we will be compliant. Blessed One, by the mere recollection of this queen of knowledge, all of us will make streams of rain fall. By its mere recollection we will also turn back excessive rain. We will not go against what the Blessed One

has commanded."

The Blessed One also bestowed the mantra words that bind by oath. Then all those nāga kings touched both feet of the Blessed One and spoke thus:

"tadyathā oṃ cata cata vicata śata śata vacarati svāhā

Blessed One, if a holder of knowledge (vidyādhara) performs the rite for a single day and night and we do not make streams of rain fall throughout all Jambudvīpa for the sake of protecting all sentient beings, Blessed One, we will have betrayed the perfectly complete Buddha. We will also die and pass away from the nāga realm of birth. Blessed One, at that time the holder of knowledge should first recite these words of the oath-binding dhāraṇī mantra seven times. After that he should throw one hundred and eight mustard seeds into the pond as seeds for the nāgas. Blessed One, then the dwellings of all of us will be wholly set ablaze, and I will be cut into pieces, piece by piece, until I die and am utterly finished, with nothing left but the remains of a skeleton. At that time all of us will swiftly make streams of rain fall. If we do not swiftly make streams of rain fall, Blessed One, then all of us will fall into the power of the time of death. We will die together with our sons and grandsons."

Then the Four Great Kings, Vaiśravaṇa and the others, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, you have spoken exceedingly terrible mantra words that bind the nāgas by oath. You have spoken merciless oath-bindings."

The Blessed One said: "Great Kings, in later times, in a future age, there will appear senseless nāgas, vicious, fierce and harmful. At that time they will be frightened by this oath; they will be terrified, and they will duly send down streams of rain in their proper seasons. In their proper seasons they will bring forth crops, flowers and fruits."

Then Great King Vaiśravaṇa said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please teach the rite in detail."

Then the Blessed One taught the rite: "When the rains do not fall, one should go to a mountain, a hermitage, a temple, a spring, a pond, a lake, a pool, a well, or a pond that is a dwelling of nāgas, and there make a triangular maṇḍala of clay mixed with cow dung. In the middle of the maṇḍala one should dig a pit one cubit deep, its mouth also one cubit across. It should be made very smooth and wiped very clean. One should sprinkle scented water all around it. In its center one should make the four great kings: with the dung of a tawny cow mixed with clay one should shape the bodies of nāga kings

with nine-headed hoods, and on all their heads one should make wish-fulfilling jewels. In the east one should make the nāga king Sāgara. In the south one should make the nāga king Chattra. In the west one should make the nāga king Varuṇa. In the north one should make the nāga king Lambukara. Each should have a retinue of seven, three-headed, two-headed and five-headed. Their bodies should be anointed with various perfumes. White and red sandalwood, surabhi sandalwood, juniper and saffron should be ground to powder and scattered. Flowers and flower garlands should be hung. The middle of that place should be strewn with puffed rice and white mustard seed. At the four corners the Four Great Kings should be placed. In the four main directions one should place images of the Buddha Śākyamuni containing relics, and stūpas containing relics. It should be adorned with silk and banners. One makes offering with the five offerings. One fumigates with aloeswood, sandalwood and turuṣka incense. Costus, spikenard, olibanum, white mustard seed, gandharasa and white lac resin are mixed with honey; one recites the mantra twenty-one times and should fumigate the nāgas with it. All around the edge of the maṇḍala one should draw lotuses with barley flour."

Make four doors, and on each of the four sides place seven basins, each filled with torma. Set out white torma and as many kinds of flavorsome food as are available. Scatter loose flowers. Set out four filled vases, and four vases filled with torma. Fumigate with guggulu incense from four censers. Light butter lamps with eight wicks.

The mantra holder (vidyādhara) performs a fire offering at the eastern door. Mixing karavīra wood, white mustard seed and red cow dung, he casts them into the fire one hundred and eight times. When the one hundred and eight offerings are complete, all the nāgas send down streams of rain. Throughout the whole of Jambudvīpa, from all four directions, they send down streams of rain. All those nāgas send down rain here. This is the first rite.

Make pills of white mustard seed, butter, honey, karavīra flowers and ground nāgakesara. Then recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over the pills. If they are thrown into a nāga lake, then the moment they are thrown all the nāgas become pleased and send down a great stream of rain. If they do not send it down at once, the bodies of all those nāgas will fall apart. Their brains will ache, and great suffering will come upon them. This is the second rite.

Stir together the ash of the fire offering and roots, and recite the mantra sixty times over it. If it reaches the inside of the dwelling, then the moment it reaches it all the nāgas become agitated, and therefore they send down streams of rain. If they do not send it down at once, spots will break out on the bodies of all the nāgas, they will be stricken with leprosy, and they will go blind. This is the third rite.

Mix juniper, blue utpala, orpiment, copper powder, white mustard seed, indrahasta and palāśa, and moisten the mixture with molasses. The wise one recites the mantra eighty times over it and makes pills the size of a juniper berry. In a time when no rain falls, if seven pills are thrown into the dwelling of the nāgas, rain will fall for seven days and nights. If they do not send it down at once, then all the water in the nāgas' dwellings will dry up, and all who live in the nāgas' dwellings will be left naked.

Tie one pill to the top of a banner and plant it in the nāga lake. Attach a blue pennant. If this mantra is written and attached there, then for as long as the banner is not taken down, all the nāgas will send down rain. Again, tie it to the top of a banner and plant it on a high rooftop. Then, at the time when hail falls, even if the nāgas would send down hail, they cannot. The nāgas see it as having the color of gold, and all the nāgas, terrified and afraid, send down rain in that place just as is wished.

oṃ suprate vajradunde mili mili svāhā

This is the mantra.

From flour make the figure of a nine-headed nāga and smear its body with vermilion. Tie a pennant at its neck. Make a square maṇḍala, place the nāga figure in its center, and scatter loose flowers over it. Offer white torma, as much as is available. Offer flowers and incense as well. Recite the mantra twenty-one times over a pomegranate twig, and with the mantra and the pomegranate twig strike the nāga figure one hundred and eight times. Then whichever nāga's name has been written, that nāga will be summoned, and that nāga will take no delight in its own home. If it does not properly send down streams of rain, its life will at once be in peril.

Recite the mantra over the white mustard seeds, one thousand and eight times for each. When the one thousand and eight are complete, all the nāga figures move and raise their hoods. After that, if one threatens them with the pomegranate twig, they rise up and show their tongues, and show even their bodies. All the nāgas come under one's control and do just as they are

commanded. Recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over milk and white mustard seed, and if this is scattered in every place, everything will be set right again. This is the fourth rite.

Then the nāga king Sāgara, together with other mighty nāga kings, a hundred thousand nāga kings, rose from their seats, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and said: "Blessed One, you have spoken extremely fierce mantra words. You have spoken extremely fierce ways of accomplishing rites. Blessed One, we too shall speak in the same way. We will send down streams of rain at the proper times. From now on we will not harm sentient beings. Blessed One, for the sake of the unruly nāgas who do harm, we wish to speak mantra words that turn back those who do not keep their pledges. May the Blessed One please bless them."

"Lords of the nāgas, I shall bless the pledge mantra. Speak it!"

namo bhagavate śākyamunaye tathāgatāya tadyathā bhuje bhuje samaya bhuje tatva bhuje prabhara bhuje samanta ākāra bhuje duru duru svāhā samaya balane svāhā nāgamara sañcodani svāhā

"Blessed One, in later times, in a later age, in order to turn back all unruly nāgas, we have spoken this nāga pledge mantra. In times of excessive rain and in times of scarce rain, at times of frost, of hail, and when hail is falling, one should call this mantra to mind. It should be recited. Then all the nāgas should be urged.

"The mantra holder should bathe thoroughly and make himself clean, put on new clothes, and go to the abode of the nāgas. At the abode of the nāgas he should make a maṇḍala of whatever fragrances are available, place an image of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, or a stūpa containing relics, upon that maṇḍala, and wash it with scented water. He should make offerings with flowers and incense. All the nāgas, too, should be bathed. He recites the mantra eight times over the water with which the image was bathed, puts white mustard seed into it, pours it into the pond, and fumigates with incense from the four directions. The moment it reaches the water, in that very instant the abode of the nāgas shakes, something like smoke arises and becomes a great mass of clouds, and covering the expanse of the sky, it sends down streams of rain.

"At the time when hail is falling, recite the mantra twenty-one times over white mustard seed mixed with sesame, and with it bind the four directions. Scatter it toward the direction of the nāgas. The hail will not fall, and all the nāgas will

be held in check."

Frost, hail and untimely winds will be completely stilled. At the shore of a nāga lake, at a well, a pond, the bank of a pool, or on a mountain peak, if one performs a fire offering one thousand and eight times with arka wood, clarified butter, mustard oil and karavīra flowers, everything will be accomplished. As soon as the fire offering has been performed, a great stream of rain will fall. When there is excessively heavy rain, if one recites a hundred and eight times over parched rice and white mustard seed and scatters them into the sky, the great rain will be turned back.

"Blessed One, if we do not let a stream of rain fall within three days, then, Blessed One, leprosy will break out upon us. We will become blind and foul-smelling in body. We would be deceiving the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. We would be deceiving the three worlds. May we fall from our birth as nāgas! Blessed One, if one applies this to all others as well, everything will be effective."

Then the Blessed One gave relief to those nāga kings, established them in the pledge, and entrusted them to the Great King Vaiśravaṇa. Having entrusted them, he departed from that place. Vaiśravaṇa remained at the site.

This concludes the chapter on bringing down rain from the Nāga Pledge.

Then, while the Blessed One was dwelling in the multi-storied palace of Brahmā, many hosts of gods arrived, and a great assembly of bodhisattvas arrived as well. Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara (Śiva), and all the mighty nāga lords arrived too. The lord of the garuḍas arrived with all his many attendants: a great king whose wings bore golden eyes, with a vajra beak, a great being whose body blazed, wrathful and of terrifying prowess, wearing on his head a crown adorned with many different jewels, with pearls and with gold, overlaid with gold, fierce in form, haughty in his gaze, with a nāga lord spread out as his seat. Vajrapāṇi, lord of the yakṣas, arrived with ten million yakṣas, and Vajradhara arrived with his retinue of a thousand vidyādharas.

The Blessed One was seated on a lion throne adorned with various precious jewels and ornamented with many different red pearls, in the multi-storied palace with its great hanging streamers, endowed with the blessing of the Tathāgata's great blessing. The Blessed One's body was exquisitely adorned with a hundred thousand koṭis of trillions of rays of light of every kind. It blazed like a golden lamp pillar and shone like the sun. He possessed the

thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks, and his body was beautifully adorned with an aura a fathom wide. The Tathāgata's body was utterly pure, and its light was clear, utterly free of stain and flaw.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the great assembly had gathered, sent forth rays of light of every kind from his body, and with the radiance of those rays he pervaded all the ten directions. Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Maheśvara looked at the Tathāgata's rays of light and saw that in Jambudvīpa the unruly nāgas had sent down frost, hail, wind and hailclouds, scorching the flowers, all the fruits, all the crops, the trees, the grasses, the shrubs, the herbs, the forests and the medicinal plants, ruining them; and that, having ruined them so that not even a branch remained in Jambudvīpa, the beings there were tormented by great suffering, and they heard the cries of their misery.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Maheśvara touched their heads to the Blessed One's feet and said this: "Blessed One, fierce nāgas with harmful intent have devastated Jambudvīpa and ruined everything, and beings are experiencing great and unbearable suffering."

The Blessed One said: "O lords of the gods, this has become plainly evident. Behold the blessing of the Tathāgata, the profound wisdom of the Buddha, and the blessing of the Tathāgata's distinctive qualities!"

Then the Blessed One entered into the samādhi called the Garuḍa's Haughty Gaze, the Magical Display with a Garland of Flames Blazing All Around. As soon as he had entered into it, his two shoulders blazed fiercely, and as soon as they blazed, the bodies of all the nāgas burst into flame.

Then the great nāga king, encircled all around by parasols, touched his head to the Blessed One's feet and said this: "Blessed One, we are burning! Sugata, we are burning!"

Then the Blessed One gave his consent by remaining silent. He looked upward and looked in all the ten directions, paid homage to all the tathāgatas, and called to mind this maṇḍala of the essence of the garuḍa's splendor, blazing all around with the garuḍa's great force.

oṃ bajrabati garuḍabege hūṃ hūṃ carisrija hūṃ phaṭ

Then those unruly nāgas began to reel and sway. They sat before the Blessed One, trembling and quaking.

Then the Blessed One spoke the great heart-essence of the Tathāgata called the Garuḍa of Blazing Flames:

namo bhagabate śākyamunaye tathāgatāya oṃ bajra jvala jvala prajvala hana hana sarba nāga hṛdaya dhāraṇī hara hara sarba kannaṃ bala bīrya parākramaṃ daha daha sarba rāga śarīraṇī paca paca sarba nāga marmāṇi garuḍa bega bakṣinipate natpataya pataya sarba nāga bhubanāni oṃ mata mata mahābicitra manimohulidaraha mahārudra begadara bicitra ābaraṇa bibuhu śītakāya sarba nāgānāṃ kara kara smara smara bho gharuḍena paratha gaṃbaṃtrana śākyamune pracana manupālaya tarjaya nāgānāṃ bakṣāya duṣṭaṃ pramadāya bāyu beja gabaṃ sphoṭaya mūrtānāna śoṣaya bidu jvalana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ pramata sarba bata aśinnemekaṃ nāśaya nāśaya sarba nāga balaṃ bahara pracaduntena āgarapāya suśā nāgana garja garja mahāgaruḍa begana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ stambhaya niśīta palahakaṃ saṃbhakṣaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ stambhaya śīta bāyu meghana sarba nāgābhihariṇi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ bho nāga madhibati muñca hrīḥ bhakṣa buyuṃ garuḍa krodha mahābega bhandhaya bāyu balaha kantiti ṭi ṭi ṭi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ bhaśaya bata śīta āśanāni nāśaya citi citi phaṭ phaṭ svāhā āśāya nāgānāna bandhaya bajra bhindena tathāgatasmantena satyena hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā ti ti ti ti hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā jalaṃ baduḥ sarba aśanta thāgata adhiṣṣānena hūṃ phaṭ amṛte mabhabatu sarba śīta bāyu bega āśani hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ mātikrama sphoṭaya nāga matikrama māte murtanaṃ yatiśiti huru huru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā bartāya svāhā nāga sphoṭaya svāhā nāga bidārāya svāhā oṃ svāhā sarba svāhā bhuba svāhā tathāgata samaya svāhā trailokyapūjitāya svāhā oṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ

"Lords of the nāgas, this great dhāraṇī called the Blazing Heart-Essence of the Tathāgata's Garuḍa averts all unruly nāgas. It destroys all clouds, frosts, winds and hailstorms. It averts them. It protects the crops. It protects flowers, fruits and forests. It brings the fruit of nectar to full ripeness. Thereby it makes what has been stored up increase.

"O lords of the nāgas, the instant you merely call this to mind, all of you who make up the circle of nāgas, together with your sons and wives, together with your ministers, together with your servants and together with your retinues, you who wield the power of frost, who wield the power of wind, who wield the power of gathering, all of you in concord: by the permission of the Tathāgata and the blessing of the Tathāgata's sacred pledge (samaya), in the future, in the latter times, here in this Jambudvīpa, guard all the crops, the flowers and all the fruits, the substances, the trees and all the medicines! Send down streams of rain at their proper seasons! Just as you would guard your own life,

protect the flowers, fruits and crops that make all the beings of Jambudvīpa thrive!

"If you do otherwise and do not act according to the Tathāgata's virtuous command, then may the homes of all the nāgas blaze, blaze fiercely, blaze fiercely on every side, burning as a single flame! May a great famine come upon the nāgas! May their strength wane and their vigor fail! May their waters dry up! May their homes dry up! May their bodies become rough! May they be beset by fear of the garuḍas, by fear of fire and sand, by constant hunger and by fear of thirst! Running this way and that, their bodies scorched all over, tormented by the heat of the sun, may their bodies be burned! May disease, harm and all kinds of contagious illness gather upon them!

"Thus, in the future, in the latter times, if unruly nāgas, fierce nāgas and exceedingly fierce ones go against this heart-essence dhāraṇī called the Tathāgata's Blazing Garuḍa, they will experience suffering such as this. Therefore, lords of the nāgas, you should keep the Tathāgata's sacred pledge with a vow of truth. You should fully protect all the beings of Jambudvīpa. You should guard them. You should accomplish this."

Then the nāga king Encircled All Around in the Shape of a Parasol, the great nāga king Sāgara, the great nāga king Nanda, Upananda, the great nāga king Manasvin, the great nāga king Hulapa, the great nāga king Varuṇa, the great nāga king called Blazing All-Holder, Open-Mouthed Crest of Great Joy, the great nāga king Brahmā's Head, the great nāga king Banner Renowned in the Three Worlds, the great nāga king Light of the Lord, the great nāga king called Widely Renowned Light, the great nāga king called Banner-Form on Every Side, the great nāga king Jewel Head, the great nāga king Well-Established Crest of Brahmā, the great nāga king Blazing Crest Jewel, the great nāga king Subduer of the Great Ocean, the great nāga king All-Seeing Eye, the great nāga king Viṣṇu's Encircling, the great nāga king Wholly Apart, the great nāga king Rain-Bringer through Great Joy, the great nāga king Pure Great Joy, the great nāga king Scatterer, the great nāga king Blazing Lightning, the great nāga king Son of the Earth-Protector, the great nāga king Manifold Rain-Bringer, the great nāga king Power of Releasing and Holding, the great nāga king Rain-Bringer upon the Three Worlds, and the great nāga king Manifold Vaiśravaṇa.

These and the rest, eighty-four thousand great nāga kings, each great nāga king having a retinue of seventy-seven thousand nāga clans, went to where

the Blessed One was. They circumambulated the Blessed One three times, worshipped him with a great offering, touched their heads to the Blessed One's feet, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, because the Blessed One has spoken these mantra words, so utterly unbearable, so greatly fierce, so very hard to behold, Blessed One, we are ruined. We are burning. Our bodies tremble violently. Our hair stands on end. Blessed One, we stand stricken with fear in the very presence of the Blessed One. Such is our terror that our flesh crawls at every pore, a great and unbearable fear has arisen, and in our dread we are utterly disheartened.

"Blessed One, in the future, in times to come, after the Tathāgata has passed completely into nirvāṇa, there will be monks of fierce conduct who are greedy for wealth. When they are entreated to turn back frost, wind and hail, then, Blessed One, how should those unruly nāgas exert themselves? How will their lives be spared? Blessed One, how will our sons and grandsons come to be many?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to those great lords of the nāgas: "Lords of the nāgas, in the future, in times to come, you should abide in loving-kindness. You should act in accordance with the pledge of the Tathāgata. Send down streams of rain at the proper times! At the proper times bring forth flowers, fruit and crops! Turn back all wind, clouds and hail! Do not bring ruin! Lords of the nāgas, therefore, in the future, in times to come, dwell without doing harm! Lords of the nāgas, if you do not truly keep the pledge, then, lords of the nāgas, great harm will befall you." Thus he spoke.

The first, the knowledge-mantra for urging the nāgas, is complete.

Then, after that, I shall set forth this rite of the root knowledge-mantra that pacifies the wrath of the nāgas, the maṇḍala of the heart-essence of the splendor of the Blazing Garuḍa.

At the very outset, looking up to the sky, if one scatters white mustard seed mixed with water in the four directions, all frost, wind, clouds and hail will be overcome. They will be bound. All the nāgas will sit trembling and quaking. Mix ash with water, recite the mantra over it twenty-one times, and if one empowers with it, protection of oneself will have been accomplished. When thunder rumbles, recite twenty-seven times over white mustard seed and seven times over water, and one should bind the clouds in the sky. Then, looking at the clouds, if one scatters the white mustard seed into the sky, all the flowers and fruit are gathered up and fall to the ground. One should also

recite the mantra and wrathfully utter phaṭ; with three utterances of phaṭ even the young nāgas will fall, and the bodies of the nāgas will break apart and fall upon the plain.

Recite twenty-one times over a twig of Nepalese pomegranate, and if one whirls it seven times in the manner of a wheel, none of the unruly nāgas will send down frost, clouds, wind or hail upon the earth. Their heads split into seven pieces. Their eyes start from their sockets. If one recites wrathfully one hundred and eight times, the nāgas, together with their clans, their clouds and all their retinues, fall upon the face of the earth. The nāgas' dwellings and all their palaces, together with their waters, trees and forests, become one single blaze of flame. All the great nāga kings, of great splendor and great might, are struck by a violent disease of the brain. If the knowledge-holder (vidyādhara) does not quickly protect them, all their clans will be ruined. Together with their sons and grandsons, their retinues and their mounts, they will be utterly wiped out. They will become blind.

In a time without rain, recite one thousand times over white mustard seed, and if one scatters it upon their dwellings, all the nāgas will tremble and quake, their dwellings and lakes will become one single blaze of flame, and they will swiftly send down streams of rain as one wishes. Again and again they will send down streams of rain.

Whenever rain is needed, the knowledge-holder should recite one hundred and eight times over water and white mustard seed, go to a high place, and sit facing east. Then, reciting the mantra seven times over each of seven handfuls of water, if one scatters them toward the east, all the nāga kings will at once gather together and send down streams of rain.

At the break of dawn, mix white mustard seed and saffron with water, recite seven times, and scatter it in the four directions; if one also scatters it above and below, a boundary will be sealed against all frost, wind, clouds and hail for a distance of up to a league on every side.

All the unruly nāgas will be bound. No nāga will transgress.

Take the dung of a tawny cow, caught before it falls to the ground, together with that same cow's butter, milk and urine. Mix it all with saptabiśaka and flour, and recite the mantra over it ninety-two times. Then make from it a five-headed nāga. Its heads should be hooded, and it should be seated cross-legged with its body coiled. Wash its body with white sandalwood and saffron. Set it on a clean seat. Empower it with a crown of silk. Hang a garland

of flowers on it.

Make a square maṇḍala, scatter loose flowers, and set out four full vases. Plant four arrows and hang four white silk banners from them. Place a torma in the center of the maṇḍala. At the four corners of the maṇḍala plant four pegs of khadira wood. Wind a thread of the five colors around them five times. Recite twenty-one times over all of these, and so perform the rite. Tie silk around the necks of the vases.

Mix nala, lac resin incense, Indian incense, kunduru, nakha, nāgapuṣpa, white mustard seed and sugar, recite one hundred and eight times over the mixture, and fumigate with it. Having prepared this incense, the mantra holder should bathe thoroughly and put on clean clothes. Then, with this very mantra, he should perform the rinsing, the binding of the rock, the binding of the boundaries, the binding of the directions, the binding of the maṇḍala, the raising of the garment, the protection of oneself, and the bathing.

Set the nāga down facing east. The mantra holder, looking toward the nāga, sits cross-legged. With this very mantra he should summon it, and with torma and incense he should send it back. Then the mantra holder recites one thousand and eight times, reciting over each single mustard seed and striking the nāga image with it. Light a lamp with four wicks. Write the nāga's name. The one that is struck will stand up.

If the thousand and eight recitations are completed, all the great nāga kings will come under one's control. They will reveal everything. They will grant whatever one wishes. They will turn back all powers. Their own people, together with their retinues, together with their sons and grandsons, will all come under one's control. They will perform every task. They will look after one as they would their own homes.

Place that nāga image in a secluded spot and offer it flowers and incense. Keep it free from disturbance and out of sight; show it to no one. It is pleased by clean cloth. Whenever there is need, recite one hundred and eight times over mustard seed and strike it, and it will accomplish everything needed. Wherever it is sent, it goes there and returns again. In dreams it will reveal all that is needed and will perform every task. This is called the nāga servant.

When untimely clouds, wind, hail and frost arise, mix grains of mustard seed with white mustard seed, recite one hundred and one times over it, and strike the nāga image with it in wrath. In that very instant the wind, the hail and the clouds will vanish, and all will be bound.

When drought occurs, write the letters, wrap them with red thread, tie twenty-one knots in the thread, and tie it around the nāga's neck. If one recites twenty-one times at the crown of the nāga's head, in that very instant streams of rain will fall, and it will rain just as the practitioner wishes. If the rain is excessively heavy, recite seven times over a blue thread and tie seven knots in it, and the heavy rain will be cut off.

For all other rites and practices of vidyā as well, this mantra is recited seven times at the very beginning. It is applicable to everything: recite it, and the practice is accomplished.

The dhāraṇī called the Maṇḍala of the Heart of the Garuḍa, the Great Garuḍa, Vajra Blazing with Force, is complete.

Then, after that, the rite of the root heart mantra was taught. The moment the dhāraṇī is uttered, all the nāgas shake and tremble.

With twigs of the pomegranate tree and twigs of the karavīra tree, one should turn back wind and clouds. With cow dung that has not fallen to the ground, make on a rooftop a square maṇḍala, clearly divided and with its sections well laid out. Plant eight khadira pegs, eight finger-widths long, in the directions and the intermediate directions. Plant five arrows. Plant a trident. Wind thread of the five colors around four of the arrows, circling them four times. Set out four full vases, incense bowls, and four torma vases. Place four filled with white torma in the center of the maṇḍala. Scatter loose flowers in abundance. Scatter parched grain and mustard seed. Recite seven times over each of these, and set them in place. Mix mustard seed with water, and by reciting over it, seal off the boundaries in the four directions.

Then a great boundary will be sealed all around, for a distance of up to a league. The unruly nāgas cannot break through it. Even the great nāgas can never send down untimely wind, clouds and hail. They cannot harm any of the flowers and fruits; never at all can they harm even a blade of grass. Restrained by the five bonds, all are bound. This will remain a sealed boundary for eight months. Yakṣas, bhūtas, rākṣasas, pretas, kumbhāṇḍas and guhyakas will not transgress this place.

Then the mantra holder sits in the center of the maṇḍala, and by reciting seven times over a pomegranate twig he should turn back the nāgas. They should not be turned back with excessive wrath.

One should form the mudrā of the cross-legged nāga: shape the two index fingers like a hooded head and stretch out the two little fingers. This is the mudrā of all the nāgas. The moment it is expressed, the hearts of all the nāgas will be afflicted.

If the nāgas wish to bring harm upon that region, then burning sand falls upon their heads. Along the whole length of their bodies, from head and tail to trunk, a stream of rain of swords will fall. Then all the nāgas will remain in fear and terror, and at that time streams of rain will fall in Jambudvīpa in due season. All the untamed nāgas will come under control.

On a rooftop one should make a square maṇḍala, strew it all over with loose flowers, and perfume it with incense. One should recite the mantra seven times over each of the vases filled with water. A torma should be set out. One should recite twenty-one times over a peg of khadira wood. If the khadira peg is planted in the center of the maṇḍala, all the harm of wind, clouds, hail and frost will be bound, and it will stay held back until the peg is pulled out.

If one recites seven times over white mustard seed and scatters it while looking at the clouds, all hail will be cut off.

If one recites twenty-one times over a karavīra twig and makes it into a bracelet, hail will be stopped everywhere.

If one recites twenty-one times over a red karavīra flower and throws it into the sky when lightning appears, the lightning will stay right there in the sky and be bound. If one recites seven times over water and sprinkles it, the lightning will be released.

When thunder rumbles, if one recites twenty-one times over a trident and plants it in the center of the maṇḍala, then until the trident is pulled out, the thunder may rumble but the clouds will be bound. Once the trident is pulled out, they will be released.

If one recites seven times over a sword, holds it with the mudrā of the cross-legged nāga, and stays looking at the clouds, then as soon as one takes hold of it, everything will blaze, and all the nāgas will be struck mute.

If one takes up the sword, recites a hundred and eight times, and draws a garuḍa upon it in saffron, then in whatever way one whirls it, in that way the garuḍa's wings will strike the bodies of the nāgas. All the nāgas will be terrified and flee in the ten directions, and afterward they will be unable to send down wind and hail.

If one mixes karavīra flowers with white mustard seed and performs a fire offering sixty times in the maṇḍala, the power of all the nāgas to bring cold, and hail, snow and the like, will be held back. Whenever rain is needed, at that time rain will fall.

One should make an image of a nāga out of beeswax, four finger-widths in size and five-headed, coat it with gold, and then cover it with a white upper cloth. One should recite the root mantra a thousand times, place the image inside a new, unused vase, and wrap it in a body cloth. It should be sealed. One should make a square maṇḍala of cow dung, scatter roasted buckwheat and white mustard seed over it, perfume it with incense, and recite this mantra. If one recites seven times over a twig of the Nepalese pomegranate tree and strikes the vase very gently, all the hail will pass into the vase. All the nāgas will come under one's control.

If one writes the names of all the nāgas on an image of a nāga king made of beeswax, then whichever nāga's name and clan one recites, that nāga will come under one's control. Together with its retinue it will sit before one in the form of a brahmin and do everything it is commanded.

There may be an unrighteous nāga king who does not protect the land and ruins the crops and fruits. One should go to that nāga's dwelling, bathe thoroughly, put on clean white clothes, and recite the spell twenty-one times. Then old women will come out of that nāga dwelling and say, "Vidyādhara, what do you seek?" Without answering, one should strike the vajra upon the ground. One should say "phaṭ." That old nāga woman will weep, crying, "Dead! Dead!" and go back into the dwelling.

Then the nāgas gather in terror, transform themselves into the form of boys, and sit before the vidyādhara, saying, "O vidyādhara, what do you seek?" The vidyādhara first recites the mantra and then, in wrath, strikes the pomegranate twig on the ground, whereupon the one in the form of a boy rolls about on the ground and says, "O vidyādhara, what do you seek?" The vidyādhara should be without compassion and knock them down in the manner of felling them. Then they say, "O vidyādhara, we will do everything you command."

Then the vidyādhara says this: "Keep the samaya of the Tathāgata!"
"We will keep it."
The vidyādhara again says this: "Take up the ten virtues!"
"We take them up."

The vidyādhara again says: "Go for refuge in the Three!"
"We accept."
"Vidyādhara, please pull out the peg."
"I will not pull it out."
Then one should say this: "Accept the recitation of the Tathāgata's samaya. Only then will I pull out the peg."

Thereupon that nāga, together with its retinue, touches its head to one's two feet. One should have them go for refuge in the Three and confer upon them the ten virtuous courses of action. One should have them take up the samaya. Only then should one pull out the peg, and right there one should also give them food, and all the nāgas will come under one's control. Say, "Enter as you would enter your own home!" They will carry out every task, whatever one wishes, just as they are commanded. Wherever they are sent, there they will go. They will do every task. In that nāga dwelling no unruly nāga will arise thereafter. Rain will fall in its due seasons. Crops will ripen in their due seasons. There flowers, fruits and leaves will be brought forth. Afterward they will do no harm.

This great dhāraṇī, which is accomplished by reciting it, should be applied to all rites. It accomplishes all rites, accomplishes the supreme, and is unsurpassed. The root mantra together with the ritual procedure for its practice is complete.

Then that king of the garuḍas bowed with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if we are to recite the dhāraṇī called The Blazing Lightning of the Vajra Beak, which makes the hearts of all nāgas blaze, averts all untimely wind, clouds and hail, brings forth all flowers, fruits and crops, and increases the soil, the essence and the vitality of the earth, then, for the sake of fulfilling all the hopes of all sentient beings, Blessed One, please bless it."

Then the Blessed One said this to the lord of the garuḍas: "Lord of the garuḍas, the dhāraṇī called The Vajra Beak is blessed. Since it has also been blessed by hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, as many as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, lord of the garuḍas, speak it in order to subdue the unruly nāgas!"

Then the lord of the garuḍas spoke this dhāraṇī called The Vajra Beak.

namo ratnatrayāya namaścaṇḍa vajra pāṇaye mahāyakṣa senāpataye namaste lokya adhivataye namaḥ caturṇāṃ mahārājānāṃ oṃ vajra dunte dunte mahādunta duti duti vajra śikhara dunte maṇi kanaka picitra āparaṇa vibhuṣita śarīre hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ nāgarāja vidravaṇi hṛdyaṃ sphoṭaya vajra duntena hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ jvalati vajra duntena hana hana garuḍa vakṣa nipatena bhasmiṃ kuru kuru kuru kuru kuru duṣṭaṃ nāgānāṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ bho bho pannāgendra sputa sputa sputantu nāga smaśāni krodharāja mahābala parākrama jvala jvala prajvala hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ bho garuḍarāja vajra dunte suvarṇa vakṣa mahābala mahākanaka vicitri ma hūṃ dar bhakṣaya duṣṭa nāgaṃ vivadu bho vāyu vala hakaṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ śoṣaya śīta valahaga garuḍa uṣmena hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ bho bho vajra dunta vicuhuna vidyud jvalana hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ vanjaya sarva śarani mātikrama simaṃ bho pannāgendra māte vajra dunten mūrṇāṃ spatayāmi hara hara prahara hūṃ phaṭ mata mata sarva nāgānāṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ tathāgata vācanamanusmara hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ vajravāṇi samayamanupālaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ trailokya adhivatervācanamanupālaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ sara sara smara smara samayamanupālaya triratna satyena hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ hrīḥ vajra dunta sarvanāga vidravaṇakara hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā triratnamanupālaya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ pramadanta hadasa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā vinicakra hata hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā maheśvara triśūla hastāya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā garuḍa teja hastāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā garuḍa vikramāya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā nāgakula nāśanāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā garuḍa sarva aśani vapanaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā sarva pāva vāyu saṃbhakṣaṇāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā sarva akāla vāta megha aśani varaṇāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā mahāvajra jvala svāhā sarva duṣṭaṃ nāga vināśakāya svāhā garuḍa hṛdāya svāhā garuḍa duntāya svāhā sarva nāśanāya svāhā oṃ duru duru svāhā muru muru svāhā turu turu svāhā diri diri duru ru ru ru ru ru ru hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

As soon as the lord of the garuḍas had uttered this dhāraṇī of the Vajra Beak, eighty hundred thousand koṭis of trillions of nāga kings fell face down. Their bodies were covered in dust, they trembled violently, and fainting, they rolled about on the ground. Crying out, "Alas! The great dhāraṇī, terrible words of mantra, has been spoken!", all of them, their bodies quaking and shaking, touched the two feet of the Blessed One and said:

"Blessed One, please protect us! Sugata, please protect us! Blessed One, from now on we will do no harm in Jambudvīpa. We will do no harm to flowers, fruits, or crops. Blessed One, we will regard this place as a stupa. Wherever this great king of rites is practiced, and wherever someone dwelling there practices it, there, Blessed One, we will always regard it as a stupa of the Tathāgata. Whether it be a country, a city, a region, a mountain crag, a village, or a temple, we will always and continually protect, guard, and shelter it. As for frost, wind, hail, and all untimely clouds, we will bring about all flowers, fruits, and crops that are rich, sweet, pleasing, tasty, tender, and delicious. We will purify all strife and wrongdoing, and we will dispel all ill omens. We will bring down streams of rain in due season. We will make flowers, fruits, and crops ripen perfectly. All dangers from flies, long-beaked mosquitoes, rats, snakes, frogs, traimabuka, makṣika, trailata, centipedes, bees, parrots, and locusts we will eliminate and utterly destroy. All epidemic diseases and contagions we will completely pacify and turn back.

"Blessed One, from now on we will not engage in the ways of sinful deeds. We will put an end to harmful rains and to all untimely rains. Blessed One, we will abide by our own sworn oath. Blessed One, we will fully keep the vows of training that are the intent of the Three Jewels. Blessed One, from now on we will not harm the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa; we will protect them as one would an only child. Blessed One, in accordance with the command of the Tathāgata, in later lives and in later times we will protect all sentient beings. We will uphold them. We will bring about virtue, happiness, and good harvests everywhere."

Then the Blessed One, having comforted the nāga kings, spoke these words: "Nāga kings, do just so! Do not neglect it!"

Then, after that, the procedure of the rite is to be explained:

This mantra, the sole hero,
Is virtuous and performs all actions.
If one with wisdom recollects it once,
It will accomplish every purpose.
In a high place the learned one
Should proclaim it with a great voice.

In whatever place it is proclaimed aloud, there untimely wind, frost, clouds, hail, and lightning can gain no hold at all. No one can rob it of its power. No one can do it harm. On a high mountain, or in a hermitage, a village, a temple,

or a very lofty dwelling, the vidyādhara, having made himself clean and having put on clean white clothes, should face east and, with cow dung mixed with earth, make a square maṇḍala one cubit in size. In the center of the maṇḍala he should plant a single arrow and recite the mantra twenty-one times.

At the four corners of the maṇḍala plant pegs of khadira wood eight finger-widths long, and recite the mantra twenty-one times. Then wind a thread of five colors around them three times. In the center of the maṇḍala set down a mound, and fumigate it with incense over which the mantra has been recited seven times. Recite twenty-one times and scatter white mustard seed. Scatter loose flowers until the maṇḍala is full. In the four directions set four torma vases. A torma should be placed in the center of the maṇḍala: lay out curd, milk, cooked rice, molasses and sugar. Recite the mantra five times over water and white mustard seed, and seal the boundaries in the four directions. The rite should be performed at the full moon.

If one reads it aloud, scatters white mustard seed in the four directions, above and below, and recites the individual names of all the nāgas, then as soon as this rite is performed, all untimely winds, clouds and hail, and all violent nāgas, will be bound and subdued. Ill omens, epidemic diseases, harms, contagious illnesses, grahas, bhūtas, piśācas, yakṣas and rākṣasas will all be driven far away. A boundary will be sealed for one league all around. All diseases, all sicknesses, all who intend harm and intend grave harm, all who counterattack and all who retaliate with harm, will be unable to prevail. All flowers, fruits and crops will come to full perfection; they will ripen fully and be delicious. All seeds well sown will sprout well. All killing rites, hostile rites and curses will be destroyed and will have no effect. As long as the pegs are not pulled out, the great boundary will remain sealed. For that long all the nāgas will send down streams of rain. All flowers, fruits and crops will come to perfection, flourishing fully. Whatever is needed, wherever it is needed, will be accomplished if one calls it to mind just once.

From beeswax make an image of a garuḍa eight finger-widths high, seated cross-legged, with wings outstretched, a nāga king spread beneath as its seat, wearing a nine-headed nāga as its head ornament, holding a three-headed nāga in its right hand and a blazing precious jewel in its left. Cover it with gold, paint it with colors according to the rite, and set it on a seat of various materials. In one day and night recite the mantra a thousand times. When the body cannot endure it, one should eat white food, then bathe again and continue the practice. Fumigate it with guggulu. Offer flowers, incense and

torma, as much as one can afford. If one lights a lamp and lies down to sleep before it, the garuḍa will appear and will tell of all the rites. It will grant every supreme thing, it will perform every rite, and it will do whatever it is commanded.

Keep it in an undisturbed place, and when drought comes, the vidyādhara should take it and honor it at the abode of the nāgas. If one places it at a lake that is an abode of nāgas, offers flowers and incense, recites the mantra three times over white mustard seed and scatters it over that abode, all the nāgas will at once send down streams of rain. If they do not at once send down streams of rain, then the nāgas will see their abodes everywhere filled with garuḍas. Their abodes will blaze up in a single mass of flame. Hot sand will fall on their heads. Their waters will dry up.

When drought comes, if the image is shown to the clouds, rain will fall. If it is shown to wind, clouds, hail, frost and storm clouds, they will vanish in an instant. Within seven leagues, in all four directions, hail will not fall, and frost and untimely winds will be unable to do harm; all will be overcome. When the winds rage, place it at a crossroads, or at the gate of the city, or at the gate of the king. By this all winds will be cut off. Even a great wind that scatters everything will be cut off, and afterward it will be unable to rise again. As soon as the image is shown, all the nāgas will scatter. Through the dhāraṇī of the Vajra Beak, by reciting the garuḍa who performs all rites, the supreme accomplishment will be attained.

Then Brahmā, Maheśvara (Śiva) and the Great Kings went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they circumambulated the Blessed One three times and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, all of us gathered together would also speak a dhāraṇī called the Beak from which the Blazing Vajra Tongue of Flame Descends, which steals the hearts of all nāgas, crushes their hearts, destroys the race of violent nāgas, dispels all wind, clouds and hail, and brings about all crops, flowers and fruits. If we offer it, then for the sake of benefiting all sentient beings, may the Blessed One please bless it."

Then the Blessed One spoke to Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara and the Four Great Kings: "Sons of good family, for the welfare, benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, recite it, blessed by me." Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara and the Four Great Kings spoke this dhāraṇī:

namo ratna trayāya namo bhagavate śākya munaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃ buddhāya nama ścaṇḍa vajra dharāya mahā bala parākramāya

nama strailokya mūrtaye namaś caturṇāṃ mahā rājānāṃ namo vajra śani jvalita raudrāṭṭa hasaya jaya mahā bala vīrya varākrama krodha rāja brahme su bradmebrahma brahma svara bho bho nāga adhi vati pi sara da vi sara mare brahma danten mūrdhanāṃ prataya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ bhara bhara vikṣu cakra hastan vośna gena du mati viṣṭa cakre śrīcchindā mi tuti tuti li li li li hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ muhu muhu muhyantu sarva duṣṭa nāgaṃ sphoṭaya hṛdayaṃ maheśvara jvalita triśūla dhara hana hana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ muci muci tuti tuti bhava bhava kṣini kṣini kṣini caturṇāṃ marici naṃ jvalita śakti dhara dhara hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ sphura sphura visphura visphura carva cvarva nāśaya duṣṭaṃ nāga hṛdayaṃ sphoṭaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ saṃhara saṃhara duṣṭaṃ yaśani vati nāga naśāti vidyuda jvala bhasmi kuru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā samaya manusmara bho nāga adhipate vajri vāya bho bho tuti tuti hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā vajra aśanāni nāśaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā sarva nāga hṛdayāni visphoṭaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā buddha vilokitāya svāhā bratmāya svāhā viṣṇu murti svāhā maheśvara jvalita triśūlāya svāhā catura mahā rāja samaya dharāya svāhā bhujaṃgāya svāhā nāga adhipataye svāhā oṃ dhiri dhiri svāhā jvalita vaktrāya svāhā roma hāra nāśāya svāhā juti juti juti svāhā phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

Then, the very moment this dhāraṇī called the Beak from which the Blazing Vajra Tongue of Flame Descends had been spoken, the bodies of all the vicious nāgas rotted and gave off a foul stench. Their bodies began to fall apart, and their flesh became blotched with sores. They touched their heads to the two feet of the Blessed One and said:

"Blessed One, please protect us! Blessed One, we have become despised by the world with its gods. Blessed One, we are ruined! Blessed One, from now on we will not harm the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa. We will not injure them. Blessed One, wherever this dhāraṇī of the Beak from which the Blazing Vajra Tongue of Flame Descends is recited, Blessed One, no nāga will go there with harmful intent. We will not even look at that place, so what need is there to speak of entering it?"

Then its rite was declared. By merely calling this dhāraṇī to mind, the bodies of all nāgas will crumble into pieces, and their bodies will stink. If one recites it twenty-one times over white mustard seed and scatters the seed in the four directions, all nāgas will be bound, and a boundary will be sealed for seven leagues all around. Having recited it one hundred and eight times over a vajra, one should turn the nāgas back. If one recites it once, all wind, clouds and hail are turned back, and all of them will vanish. By merely calling it to mind, all

hail will vanish in an instant. Even if hail does fall, in a moment it will turn to water. At the time when hail is falling, if one whirls a vajra, then in whatever direction one whirls it the hail will be driven off, and in that direction hail will not fall.

Going to a solitary place, one should enter into inward meditative absorption, bind the mudrā of the cross-legged posture, and recite this mantra thirty-two times. The moment it is recited, all wind, clouds and hail will vanish. All winds will be utterly destroyed and will no longer arise. If one scatters white mustard seed in the four directions, a boundary will be sealed all around for one year. All wind, clouds and hail will be bound, and all nāgas will come under one's control. Their sons and grandsons, together with their retinues, will follow behind one constantly and without interruption, and they will perform every task. If one recites it twenty-one times over a bell and rings the bell at the time when hail is falling, the brains of all the vicious nāgas will split. They will fall from the sky to the ground and will perform every task. This dhāraṇī will be unobstructed everywhere.

Then the Blessed One granted his approval, saying "Excellent!", to the great lord of garuḍas, to Brahmā, to Viṣṇu and to Maheśvara (Śiva): "Great Brahmā, for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, and in order to tame, subdue and punish the vicious, merciless and harmful nāgas, you have spoken these words of the dhāraṇī-mantra of great knowledge and established them in Jambudvīpa. Excellent, excellent!"

Then the great nāga king Sāgara, the great nāga king All-Encircling, other great nāga kings of great splendor and great miraculous power, and many tens of millions of vicious nāgas besides went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, we and our retinues, in the future, in times to come, shall guard the flowers, fruits, crops, leaves and branches of all Jambudvīpa. We shall protect them completely. We shall turn back all wind, clouds, hail, frost and scorching heat. We shall send down streams of rain at the proper seasons. By the pledge of our own oath we shall keep the sacred commitment of the Tathāgata. We shall fulfil the hopes of all sentient beings and accomplish their wishes. We shall do no harm. Blessed One, if we should act against the special qualities of the mantras and dhāraṇīs explained above in this king of rites, may we never fully awaken to perfect enlightenment. This is the oath we swear:

tadyathā pakicati śuli śumuli śaśa śuśu titi viriti huyu huyu huriti svāhā

Blessed One, this is the oath of the nāgas. In the future, in times to come, it will bring destruction upon the vicious nāgas."

"When drought, great drought, untimely rain, wind, clouds, hail, frost, untimely wind, or lightning occur, the vidyādhara, facing east on a mountain or on top of a tall building, should praise with these oaths, recite them seven times, and scatter water mixed with white mustard seed in the four directions. As soon as one scatters it and calls them to mind, the bodies of all the nāgas will split into a hundred pieces. They will burst apart. They will be summoned, and for that reason they will send down a stream of rain."

The Blessed One declared, "King of the nāgas, do just that!"

The rite of The Vajra Beak is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The city name Gyokdor (gyog 'dor) and the brahmin's name, rendered here as Peerless Eye (khyad ma spyan), could not be identified with a Sanskrit original. The city is given in phonetics and the name is translated by meaning. The phrase "rain falling as tongues of flame" renders lce 'bab pa'i char, whose exact sense is uncertain; it may refer to lightning.
• The great sage □□□□□□□□ (literally "one who casts off faults") could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit name and is therefore translated literally as "Casting Off Faults"; it may render an Indian ṛṣi's name. The meaning of "seven coiled figures" (presumably serpent coils) and some of the creature names, such as shrews, gnats and the insects traimabuka and trailata, are uncertain.
• The sage's name, □□□□□□□□, could not be identified with a standard Sanskrit form, so it is translated by meaning as "Casting Off Faults." The dhāraṇī he speaks pays homage to the great sage Agastya, so he may be meant as Agastya. The preceding passage gave this name as the sound-spelling "Nyé Dor." House rules forbid Tibetan sound-spellings, so that earlier rendering should be changed to "Casting Off Faults" to keep one form throughout. Many of the pest names (picilika, traimabuka, trailata, viśakitaka, lomika, kantika, śaṅganika, māluśika, madurika, khanajanaka) are Sanskrit words transcribed in Tibetan letters. They are given here in romanized form because they cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□□ in the description of the Buddha's company is rendered tentatively as "train of attendants."
• The phrase rendered "his great attendant" is uncertain; the Tibetan is obscure and may be a name or an epithet. The nāga king "Encircled All Around in the Shape of a Parasol" and the yakṣa "Scattering Wind" could not be identified with a known Sanskrit name, so their names are translated by meaning. "Nor did they call the Blessed One to mind" takes the nāgas as the subject, which the sentence leaves implicit; it could also be read as "nor did the Blessed One recollect them." "Untamed nāgas" reads the uncommon word bgrungs in the sense of "subdued". The list "eighty thousand nāga kings, the nāga king Sāgara and others" could also be read as "headed by Sāgara", with the parasol-shaped nāga king as the one who rises.
• The sentence "The Blessed One also bestowed the mantra words that bind by oath" uses an honorific past verb, so it is taken as narration, though the mantra that follows is spoken by the nāga kings themselves; it could alternatively be read as part of their speech. The phrase

rendered "we are all scorched, we who were vicious" is somewhat unclear in the Tibetan. "There will be no guile in the hearts" (g.yo ma mchis) might also mean "our hearts will cease to stir." "Senseless" for □□□□□□□□□ is tentative. The "four great kings" made in the center of the maṇḍala are evidently the four nāga kings listed next, as distinct from the Four Great Kings placed at the corners. The southern nāga king □□□□□ is rendered Chattra ("Parasol") as a likely Sanskrit equivalent; identification uncertain. Several incense ingredients (□□□□□□□□ costus, □□□□□□□□□□□□ lac resin) are approximate identifications.

• The term rendered "red cow dung" (lci tsha dmar po) is uncertain. Lci ba is dung, but the exact substance is unclear. "Terrified and afraid" reads the written dang ngas as dngangs, an evident slip. "The wise one recites" reads the genitive gyi in shes rab can gyi as the instrumental. The verb pho in "if it reaches" is taken in the sense of "reach, touch," which is uncertain. "Roots" for rtsa ba mo is tentative. "Palāśa" for ba la sha and "orpiment" for ba bla are probable identifications. The nāgas' speech uses humble verb forms throughout, which shows that the closing ritual instructions are still part of their address to the Buddha.

• "Within three days" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact time span is uncertain. It could also mean "three years" or "the three times of day." The nāgas' "we are burning" reads □□□ as "to be burnt," which fits the context of their blazing bodies. Here □□□□□ is read as "parasols." Elsewhere in this text the drafts treat it as the name Chattra, so "the great nāga king Chattra, encircled all around" is a possible alternative reading. Following the name list for this text, □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered as the name Vajradhara.

• The phrase rendered "it makes what has been stored up increase" reads bstabs pa, a word of uncertain sense here; it may refer to provisions, offerings or abundance in general. "Who wield the power of gathering" translates sdud la stobs byed pa literally; it likely refers to the nāgas' power to gather clouds or rain, but the text does not say so explicitly.

• Apart from Sāgara, Nanda, Upananda, Manasvin, Varuṇa and Vaiśravaṇa, the nāga kings' names could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning. Hulapa is kept as the Tibetan transliterates it. The phrase "Encircled All Around in the Shape of a Parasol" is taken as the name of the first nāga king in the list, in keeping with this text's name list. It could instead describe the assembly, the nāga kings surrounded on every side by parasols. The obscure word rendered "stricken with fear" (bas par) is read from context. "Unruly" translates mi bgrungs ba, evidently the same as mi srun pa, the reading found in the next piece. "League" renders dpag tshad (Skt. yojana).

• "Saptabiśaka" is a transliterated substance name in the Tibetan that I could not identify; it is left as spelled. Several ritual terms are uncertain. "Binding of the rock" renders □□□□□□□□□□ literally, and the word may be a slip for another term in the preliminary sequence. "Raising of the garment" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ literally. "The one that is struck" takes □□□□□□□□ as a variant of □□□□□, "struck." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as a variant spelling of □□□□□□, a kind of mustard seed used in rites. "They will turn back all powers" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; its exact sense is unclear. In the final line, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "untamed nāgas," probably a variant of □□□□□□□□□. □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "mantra holder" for consistency with the preceding passage; it refers to the vidyādhara, the tantric practitioner.

• "Roasted buckwheat" renders □□□□□□, read as buckwheat plus parched grain; the exact substance is uncertain. □□□□□□□□ in the red-flower rite is taken as a variant spelling of karavīra (oleander). "Nepalese pomegranate" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□. The rendering of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as "hundreds of thousands of millions of billions" stands for hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas. "Name and clan" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; □□□□ may stand for □□□ (the spell), giving "recites the spell with whichever nāga's name." "Head" in "touches its head to one's two feet" is implied by the idiom, not written.

• The number of nāga kings renders a compound of very large units (koṭi and khrag khrig, here given as "trillions"). The exact magnitude intended is uncertain. Traimabuka, makṣika, and

trailata are Sanskrit insect or vermin names transliterated in the Tibetan and left as such; makṣika normally means a fly. The sentence beginning "As for frost, wind, hail, and all untimely clouds" has no explicit verb for those items in the Tibetan. The sense is presumably that the nāgas will avert them and instead produce good crops. "A single arrow" renders a phrase that could also be read as an object "about an arrow's length."
• "Mound" renders the obscure □□□□□□, whose sense here is uncertain. "Hot sand" reads □□□□□ as □□□□□□, since "hot bird" makes little sense; hot sand falling on nāgas is a familiar torment. The first list of visitors names only Brahmā, Maheśvara and the Great Kings, while the Buddha's reply also names Viṣṇu and the Four Great Kings. The translation follows the text as it stands.
• The phrase rendered "their flesh became blotched with sores" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact sense is unclear. In "going to a solitary place," the Tibetan reads □□□□□ ("to a sick person"), which makes little sense here. It is taken as a slip for a word meaning "to a solitary place." The expression □□□□□□□□, translated "all around," is obscure. The nāga king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit name and is translated by meaning as "All-Encircling." In the last sentence the humble verb could also be read with the nāgas as subject: "we shall destroy the vicious nāgas."
• The verb rendered "they will be summoned" could also mean "they will be bent" or "they will be subdued". "Summoned" was chosen because the nāgas then send down rain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.